

Interdisciplinary Studies

Master of Arts

Himanshu Grover, Program Coordinator

308-C James I. Dawson Bldg

Voice: (256) 372-2990, himanshu.grover@aamu.edu

PROGRAM DESCRIPTION

The Master of Arts in Interdisciplinary Studies is a flexible, student-driven graduate program designed for those seeking to integrate two or more academic disciplines into a coherent plan of study tailored to their intellectual interests and career objectives.

Drawing on the strengths of Alabama's leading interdisciplinary programs, the curriculum encourages advanced critical thinking, creative problem-solving, research, and communication skills suited for a dynamic workforce.

Students in the program develop a personalized course of study in collaboration with faculty advisors, selecting coursework from graduate offerings across the university. The program supports both arts/humanities-focused and STEM/social sciences-focused pathways and is structured to accommodate both working professionals and full-time students with course options available in-person, online, and hybrid formats. The program offers flexible delivery (on-campus, online, hybrid) of some coursework to support a diverse student body.

ADMISSION REQUIREMENTS

Please see the general graduate admission requirements [here](#). Specific requirements to this program are –

- Applicants must hold a bachelor's degree from an accredited institution and submit a statement of interdisciplinary goals as part of the application.

DEGREE REQUIREMENTS

Students in the IDS program develop a personalized course of study in collaboration with faculty advisors, selecting coursework from graduate offerings across the university. The program supports both arts/humanities-focused and STEM/social sciences-focused pathways and is structured to accommodate both working professionals and full-time students with course options available in-person, online, and hybrid formats.

Degree Options

- Thesis Track:** Complete a substantial interdisciplinary research project that addresses a complex question or problem across chosen fields.
- Non-Thesis (Capstone) Track:** Complete a supervised capstone project or graded internship demonstrating leadership, practice-based inquiry, or applied skills relevant to career goals.

Specializations

Students select areas of emphasis reflective of major interdisciplinary themes in consultation with the program advisors or program coordinator.

PROGRAM REQUIREMENTS

Minimum of 30 graduate credit hours

- 3 credits - Interdisciplinary core seminar (IDS 500 Research Methods for the Master of Arts in Interdisciplinary Studies / IDS 505 Capstone Seminar Interdisciplinary Studies)
- 12 credits in selected specialization track
- 9 credits - Electives approved by advisors
- 6 credits - A thesis or Capstone project

(IDS) Interdisciplinary Studies – Thesis

30 Credit Hours

MinGPA cumulative 3.0. MinGrade C*. Degree M.A.

REQUIRED COURSES	
IDST 500 Research Methods	3
5xx-7xx graduate courses ² [no overlap]	9
SPECIALIZATION¹	12
THESIS	
Grade is Pass / Fail. MinHrs 6.	
IDST 599 Masters Thesis	1-6
Oral Defense	

*One grade of C allowed at graduation.

¹Students can pick any graduate courses related to a specific discipline with advisor approval.

²Students can pick any graduate courses related to any discipline with advisor approval.

Note: 1/3 of credit hours must be obtained at AAMU.

(IDS) Interdisciplinary Studies – Non-Thesis

30 Credit Hours

MinGPA cumulative 3.0. MinGrade C*. Degree M.A.

REQUIRED COURSES	
IDST 505 Capstone Seminar	3
5xx-7xx graduate courses [no overlap]	9
SPECIALIZATION¹	15
REPORT	
Grade is Pass / Fail.	
IDST 598 Research Report [RPP]	3
COMPREHENSIVE EXAM	
Grade is Pass / Fail.	
Written exam composed jointly by Advisory Committee.	
To be taken after completion of required course work.	

*One grade of C allowed at graduation.

[RPP] = Research project paper or portfolio required.

¹Students can pick any graduate courses related to a specific discipline with advisor approval.

Note: 1/3 of credit hours must be obtained at AAMU.